supports OpenTelemetry via an embedded collector and has been replatformed on OpenTelemetry (http://mng.bz/G91q). In addition to the CloudWatch agent, AWS already offers an OpenTelemetry-compliant collector via its AWS Distro for OpenTelemetry (https://aws.amazon.com/otel/).

- Azure is in the process of deprecating its Log Analytics agent and Telegraf agents in favor of the new Azure Monitor agent (AMA; http://mng.bz/2DNd). And just like the other cloud providers, Azure is (in the long term) standardizing on OpenTelemetry (http://mng.bz/vn0p).
- Similar to Azure, Google Cloud is moving away from its legacy, collectd-based monitoring agent, in favor of the new Ops Agent (https://cloud.google.com/monitoring/agent/ops-agent), which uses Fluent Bit for log collection and routing, as well as the OpenTelemetry collector, for metrics.
- Vector (https://vector.dev/docs/about/what-is-vector/) by Datadog is an interesting open source project that, to some extent, competes with OpenTelemetry, from the universal signal type support angle; however, it also supports OpenTelemetry. It seems like a good choice of agent if you're all in with Datadog.

Now that we have a good understanding of which agents exist, their coverage, and use cases, let us move on to the topic of how you should go about selecting an agent.

4.5 Selecting an agent

As is often the case, there are several choices available to you. It's important to make sure you pick an agent that is a good fit for your workloads, environment, and organizational capabilities.

It doesn't hurt to consume general material on the topic, such as blog posts and articles—for example, see "Logstash, Fluentd, Fluent Bit, or Vector? How to Choose the Right Open-Source Log Collector" (http://mng.bz/4DrR) or "Who Is the Winner: Comparing Vector, Fluent Bit, Fluentd Performance (https://medium.com/ibm-cloud/log-collectors-performance-benchmarking-8c5218a08fea); however, you should use them as an inspiration or starting point rather than a "buyer's guide." In other words, it is very likely you will have to do your own evaluation, based on your needs and preferences, to properly select an agent. In no particular order, I present you with criteria you can use as, at the very least, a starting point to evaluate agents and pick what's right for you.

4.5.1 Security for and of the agent

Where I work, at AWS, security is the highest priority, so I start with this. It is important to consider both the security *of* the agent and the security *for* the agent, by which I mean the following:

- With security *for* the agent, ask yourself and/or the vendor the following:
  - Who handles CVEs and security patches?
  - Is the agent pen tested and, if so, when (e.g., one-off, regularly, or when major components change)?